

External Storage

Although behind Transcend overall, people believe that Kingston has better after-sales support than the former

HDTVs

Top-of-mind recall: 50% Sony, 33% Samsung and 17% LG. Not one person named another brand as the first they think of

Icons of Trust

External Storage

A volatile market

Storage, whether hard drive- or flash-based, is notorious for being a volatile market. The only other segment that's considered more volatile is the memory market, as most of us going out to buy any of these products can testify. There never seems to be a right time to buy here, with prices changing often.

This year, the term external storage seemed to have more people thinking hard drives, rather than flash drives – a stark contrast from last year, when flash ruled. As a result, we have some ridiculous comebacks, such as Western Digital's 11 rank upheaval to second – up from last place just a year ago. Seagate took top spot this year, a rise of eight placing over last year's placement of ninth. All this climbing had to be done by standing on someone's shoulders, and the unfortunate ones were Apacer (fell eight spots), Hitachi and Samsung (both fell 5 spots).

It's categories like this that tell us a lot about the markets and buying trends, and these results are all the more important to

brands who want to stay ahead in such volatile circumstances. We had three new entrants to this category: HP in at eighth, OCZ in at twelfth and Freecom in at fifteenth.

When it came to awareness, Seagate, Transcend and Western Digital (WD) led the pack by a comfortable margin. Top of mind recall saw half of our respondents name Seagate as the brand that first came to mind. The other half either put in Transcend or Western Digital, with hardly anyone else naming the other brands in this survey. Aided recall helped that a lot, but Seagate, Transcend and Sandisk stayed the top three, respectively.

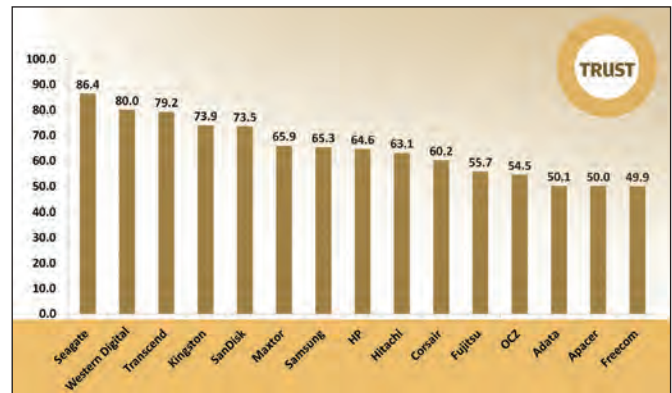
When it came to credibility,



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Seagate took top spot in all questions. Western Digital was second throughout as well, except that when asked about ease of use, Transcend scored more than WD. Kingston and Sandisk were pretty much left fighting for fourth place.

In terms of Satisfaction, almost



I am an engineer, so I understand the technical aspects of these drives. I've tried other brands and see that the performance is the best in WD, especially the response time.

Gaurav Salvi, Vasai

everywhere, Seagate ruled again. The only place it lost out on was availability in retail stores, where it lost to Transcend. WD and Transcend effectively fought for

differentiating with the time taken to resolve queries and problems with the products.

The top five also seem to have very loyal customers, and despite all our grilling and questioning, the margins for our loyalty test weren't very large. The same also held true for total cost of ownership. This category, although very volatile, seems to have thrown up very little variation in terms of the parameters that we calculate trust on.

Congratulations to the top five, but as we can have only one winner, Seagate takes the crown.

HDTVs

Fighting for every pixel

This is a new category this year, and is perhaps one of the most popular in middle- to upper-class houses. It's almost a status symbol these days, the way cars are, with success being measured by the size of HDTV you own. The results put Sony at the top, by a wafer thin margin, over Samsung, who in turn just edged LG out for second.

Based on the responses, the average Indian has only one of three answers if you ask them to name the brand that first springs to mind – Sony, Samsung or LG. Not a single person named any of the other brands as the first that comes to mind – the surest symbol of a stranglehold by the top three.

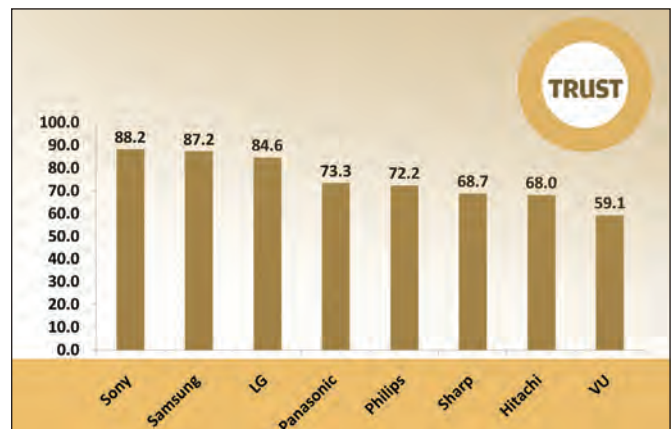
Philips and Panasonic were pretty up there with the big

three once respondents were helped out with a list.

In terms of credibility, the top three remained unchanged, again. Samsung edged out Sony in terms of style and design, but only just. LG led from the front in terms of ease of use, with more people believing that their products are easier to use than Sony or Samsung.

Those who purchase from these three brands also seem to be a satisfied lot. All three were said to be really easily available, gave out enough information, and had pretty well-educated sales people. Samsung was a teeny tiny bit ahead of Sony in terms of after sales service, and also for making all their models available at most retail stores.

It's in the total cost of ownership that everything is



I like LG because it provides options. It has excellent picture quality and I can use it with everything – DVD player and computer as well.

Sankar Baisnab, Kolkata

turned around. Sony, our leader in all the other parameters fell to sixth place. Samsung and LG stayed at the top, thus indicating that they have the right price points, and people generally find Sony to be expensive to buy and

maintain. Panasonic, Philips and Sharp were also considered to have a better TCO than Sony.

Overall, winning in four of the five parameters was enough to keep Sony at the top, but not by much, as you can see.